

Workshop

We show you how to make your existing installation of Windows 7 or 8 look and feel like Windows 10

**Microsoft Explains**

Feared that Windows 10 might block your pirated games? Check out here how it happens: <http://dgit.in/winxprrtdgms>

Of accidental water spills on precious components, noisy PCs and power fluctuations...

For all the times when you're stuck between a rock and a hard place as far as technology is concerned, we're here to help you troubleshoot it all. Just follow our trail of breadcrumbs and you'll be sorted.

Q Power fluctuation causing trouble

Hi Team Digit, I live in Hisar, Haryana and I've been having a problem with my PC that I mainly use for designing work. The area that I live in suffers from frequent power cuts and fluctuations which I think has wreaked havoc on my system. Lately, I have seen that right after a power fluctuation happens, my PC restarts immediately. Not only that, the PC completely shuts down once there is a power loss which is absolutely weird considering I have a UPS connected to the system for power backup. My system is hardly a few months old and the UPS should be around one and a half years old. Can this problem be because of my UPS? I can't seem to understand where the problem lies. Please help. Here are my system specifications:

- Processor: AMD FX 8320;
- Motherboard: Gigabyte GA-970A-DS3P;
- RAM: Kingston 8GB;
- Graphics Card: ZOTAC GTX 560;
- Storage: 2TB WD Hard Drive;
- PSU: Cooler Master 750 Watts
- UPS: APC 1000 VA

—Ashish Chauhan

A Hi Ashish! Power issues can take place because of a number of things. From what you've described, it seems like your PC's UPS is to blame here. Firstly, only connect your system to the UPS and nothing else, also make sure that you switch off all high power consuming devices in your house like an Air-Conditioner for example and work on your PC until the power fluctuations happen. Now to check whether there really is a problem with your UPS, get hold

of someone else's UPS, connect it to your system and see if the same problem arises, if not then you should get your UPS repaired or get a new one. If for some reason you find that the UPS is actually fine, then the issue can also exist because of a faulty Power Supply. So you should also replace your power supply with someone else's and check again if the restarting issue persists during power fluctuation. If yes then send your PSU for RMA. Also, it'll be good if you can call in an electrician at your place and get the wiring checked for potential issues.

Q I spilled on it, maybe I killed it?

Hi! I built a decent gaming rig for myself just a couple of months ago and I did a stupid thing of keeping a glass of water on the top of my PC case as the glass toppled and some water went inside the case from the top vents while most of it fell on the side of the case. I hurriedly switched off the PC and opened the cabinet to inspect the damage caused. I saw that the CPU heatsink fins had a few drops of water on them and so did the heatspreaders on the RAM and the backside of my precious GPU. But the worst hit according to me was the power supply as I think quite a lot of water drops went inside it from the fan area. In order to inspect properly, I removed a few components like the GPU, RAM and CPU heatsink from the system and laid them out on a table for two whole days under an incandescent light bulb. I also checked the slots on the motherboard for water drops and wiped off every area I could find inside that might've gone wet. In fear of voiding

my PSU's warranty, I didn't open it to clean it but I kept it to dry out for almost four days and also shook it to make water come out if there was any inside. Then after much deliberation I re-installed all the components and powered on the PC again. I was happy to see that the PC booted up properly without any hiccups but after a few minutes of using, it shut down automatically. This was scary to witness and that's why I didn't power on my PC again after that. What do you think is wrong with my system? Will it work again? Please advise.

—Parthiv Shah

A Water is the worst enemy of computer components and you should always keep it far away from them. Now that the damage is already done, you have a few options at your disposal. Since the PC was on during this unfortunate incident, it could've easily short circuited something or the other but it's possible that it might've not. Most of the times, it takes around a week or so for water to dry out completely which is hugely dependent on the humidity of the place where you live. The best course of action is to take apart everything from the system including cables and leave all of it outside to dry. And you should keep changing the position in which the components are sitting after every few hours that is by tilting the components at different angles so that water can get out of particular areas if there's any still left. As for your Power Supply, let it dry out the same way as said above. Almost every good PSU these days comes with good circuit protection and since only a little bit of water went in and you managed to run the system for a for a